

Chelonia mydas

Green Sea Turtle

Family (Cheloniidae)

Kingdom (Animalia)

Status (Endangered)

Description

The green sea turtle grows to a maximum size of about 4 feet and a weight of 440 pounds. It has a heart-shaped shell, small head, and single-clawed flippers. Color is variable. Hatchlings generally have a black carapace, white plastron, and white margins on the shell and limbs.



Location/Habitat

Chelonia mydas are found worldwide, primarily inhabiting tropical and subtropical coastal waters, seagrass beds, and reefs in the Atlantic, Pacific, and Indian Oceans, as well as the Mediterranean Sea. They migrate long distances between, typically, warm-water feeding grounds and nesting sandy beaches.

Sources: <https://www.fws.gov/species/search>

<https://ecos.fws.gov/ecp/report/species-listings-by-state-totals?statusCategory=Listed>
<https://efotg.sc.egov.usda.gov/#/state/CR/documents/section=4&folder=-3>